

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Systems of two linear equations in two variables	Hard

Question

$-x - wy = -337$

$2x - wy = 47$

In the given system of equations, w is a constant. In the xy -plane, the graphs of these equations intersect at the point $(q, 19)$, where q is a constant. What is the value of w ?

Correct Answer: 11

Rationale

The correct answer is **11**. It's given that the graphs of the equations in the given system intersect at the point $(q, 19)$, where q is a constant. Therefore, the coordinates of this point must satisfy both equations. Substituting the point $(q, 19)$ into the first equation, $-x - wy = -337$, yields $-q - w(19) = -337$. Adding $19w$ to both sides of this equation yields $-q = -337 + 19w$, which is equivalent to $q = 337 - 19w$. Substituting the point $(q, 19)$ into the second equation yields $2q - w(19) = 47$. Substituting $337 - 19w$ in place of q in the equation $2q - w(19) = 47$ yields $2(337 - 19w) - 19w = 47$. Applying the distributive property to the left-hand side of this equation yields $674 - 38w - 19w = 47$. Combining like terms on the left-hand side of this equation yields $674 - 57w = 47$. Subtracting 674 from both sides of this equation yields $-57w = -627$. Dividing both sides of this equation by -57 yields $w = 11$.